Chapter 18

O kovuaka – The top thatch sheet

Enoch Horai Magum

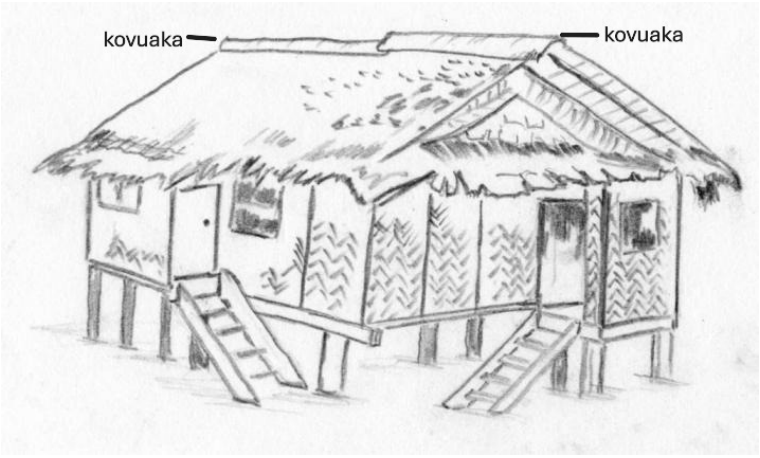


Figure 1: *Kovuaka* – Top thatch sheet

(1) *O kovuaka eve to vatotomo nana bona a bua vaave vaa tea bua papa na inu.*
The top thatch sheet joins the two roofings on the two sides of the house together.

(2) *A kiu nae he na paku vonaen:*
The work on it is done as follows:

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(3)	*Eara huha rara a ta buaku a ta atovo, eara repaa vaakopo e toon no vatetekoio bono obai ge sareai.*	We sew two thatch sheets together, then we fix them as a cover on top of the upper ridgepole with (strings made of) the calamus cane or the *sareai* vine.
(4)	*A bua ta atovo vaarii he toro bebeahu vaantee bona inu ge o vaatetekoio.*	These two thatch sheets must be as long as the house or the upper ridgepole.
(5)	*Eara repaa kisi taono e bono vaatetekoio, na kisi rara bono kara obai ge sareai.*	Then we tie them together on top of the upper ridgepole, using strings made of the calamus cane or the *sareai* vine.
(6)	*Eara repaa mosi pete to pakoo.*	Then we cut an Albert Palm.[1]
(7)	*Eara repaa mosi kurusu vaantee a bebeahu na inu ge o vatetekoio.*	We cut it exactly according to the length of the house or the upper ridgepole.
(8)	*Erau eara repaa kopaa e, eara repaa kasi a komanae.*	Then we cut it lengthwise into halves and dig out its inside.
(9)	*Beara kasi vakavara e, eara repaa vaakopo taono mae bona bua ta atovo vai to paa vaobete vaevuru ara.*	When we have dug it out, we put the halves of the palm stem as a cover on top of the two thatch sheets that we have already laid there.
(10)	*Ei kokopo taono vai maa bona bua ta atovo,*	Now it covers the two thatch sheets,
(11)	*eara repaa kisi taono bana koa e bono vaatetekoio bono kara obai.*	and we tie it to the ridgepole with the calamus cane string.
(12)	*Evei a sii kiu vaa teo kovuaka.*	This is the little work of the top thatch sheet.

[1]See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-pakoo_1